

# Master AI by Solving Job Bottlenecks

A proposed Board model built around real work, voluntary SIGs, and the loop:

**LEARN → APPLY → TEACH BACK**

**BOARD DISCUSSION**

**How do we turn daily work  
problems into AI mastery—  
and AILA thought  
leadership?**

# The member question is not “Which course should I take?”

It is:

## “What do I need AI to help me do now?”

That reframes learning around a real goal, a real bottleneck, and an immediate reason to apply the skill.

Role

Goal

Bottleneck

AI help

**Personal relevance becomes the entry point to mastery.**



# Passive AI learning is easy to consume—and easy to lose

## 1 Course-first

- Learn concepts in isolation
- Complete a module
- Return to work later
- Hope the knowledge transfers

## 2 Problem-first

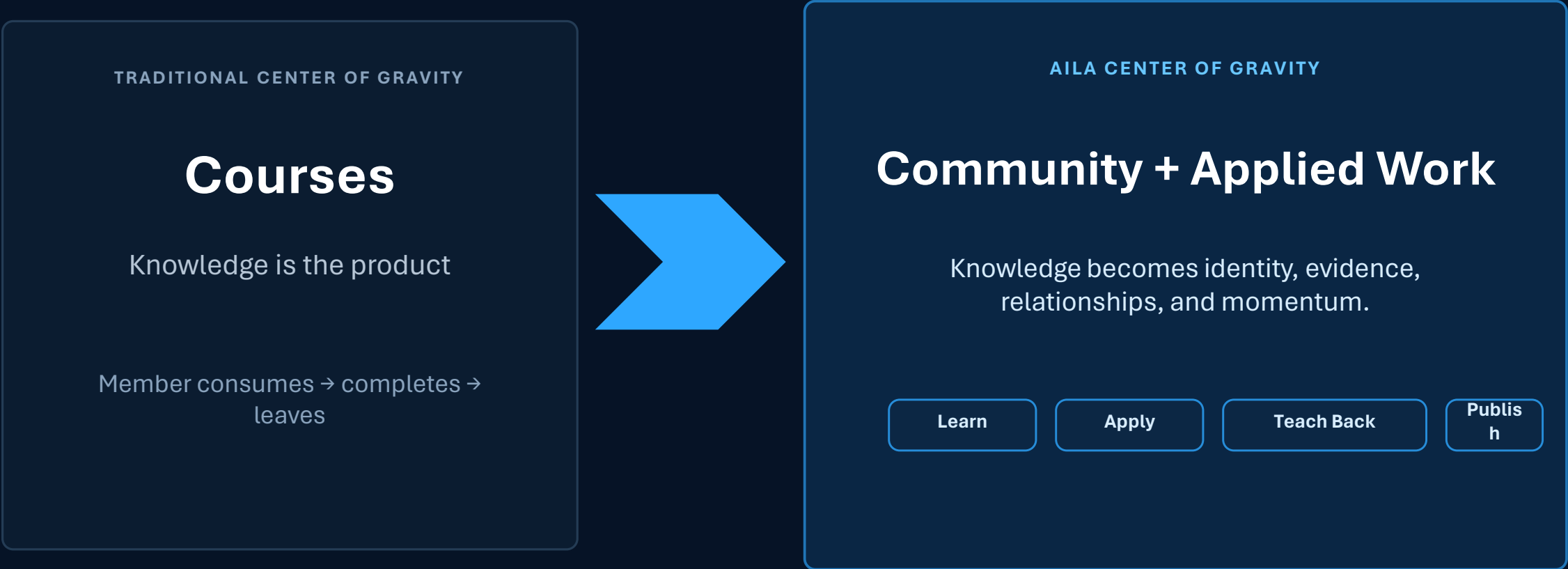
- Bring a real bottleneck
- Pull in the needed skill
- Apply it immediately
- Capture what actually worked

## 3 Community-first

- Teach back the result
- Get peer critique
- Improve the practice
- Turn experience into shared knowledge

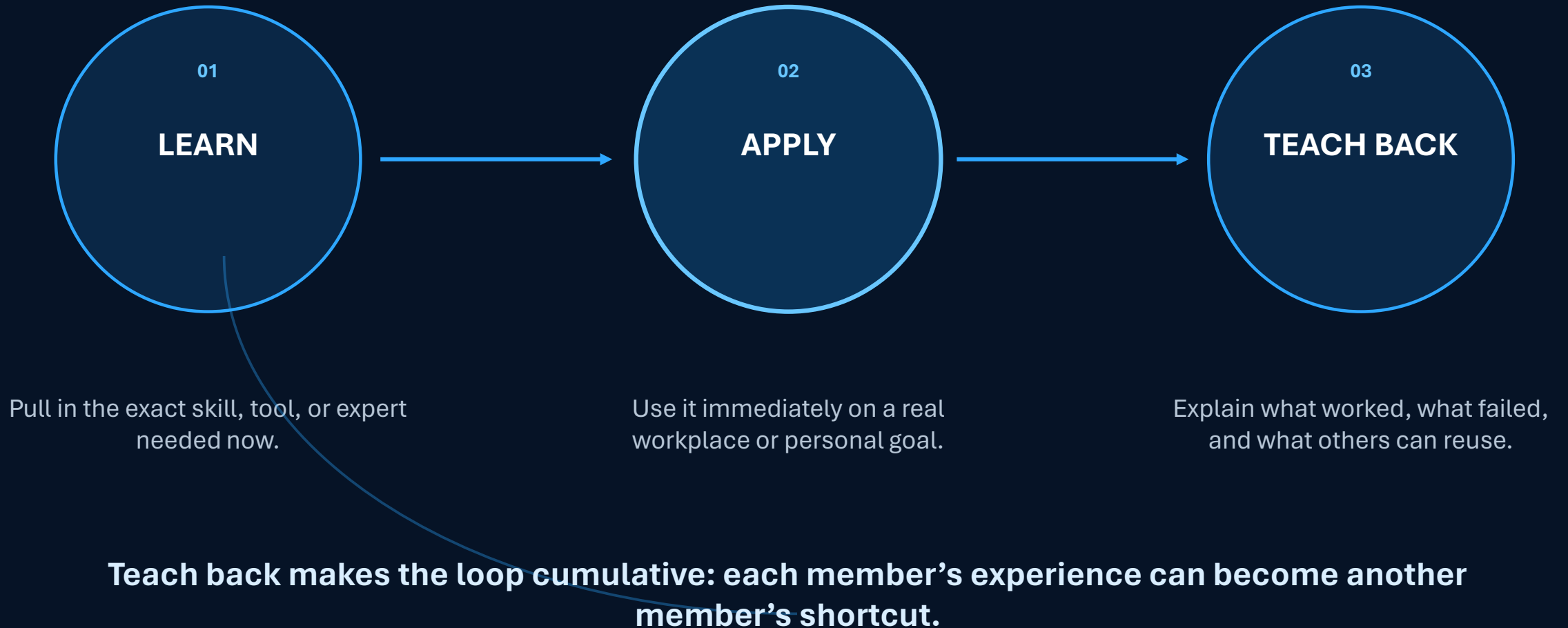
The shift is from “learning about AI” to “learning by changing real work.”

# AILA’s strategic shift: from learning provider to progress ecosystem

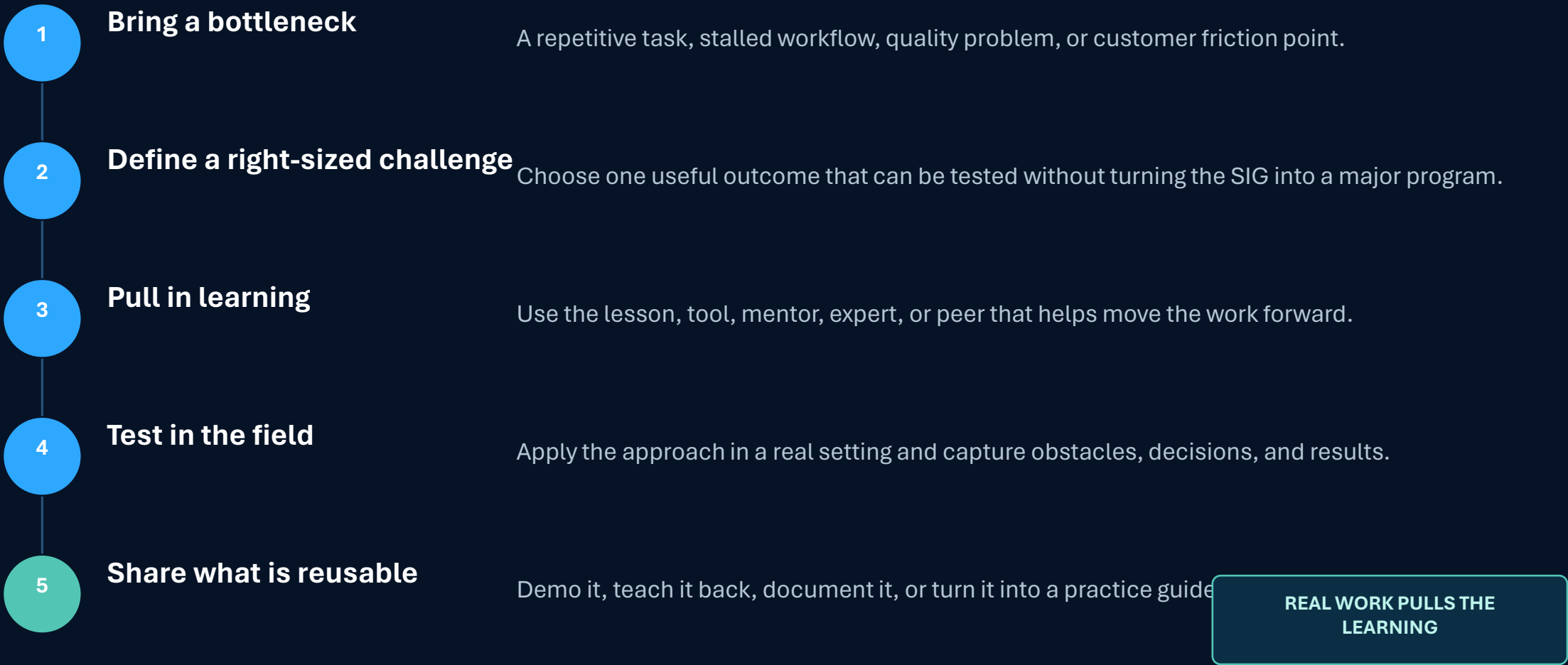


**Courses remain important. They become one part of a larger value system.**

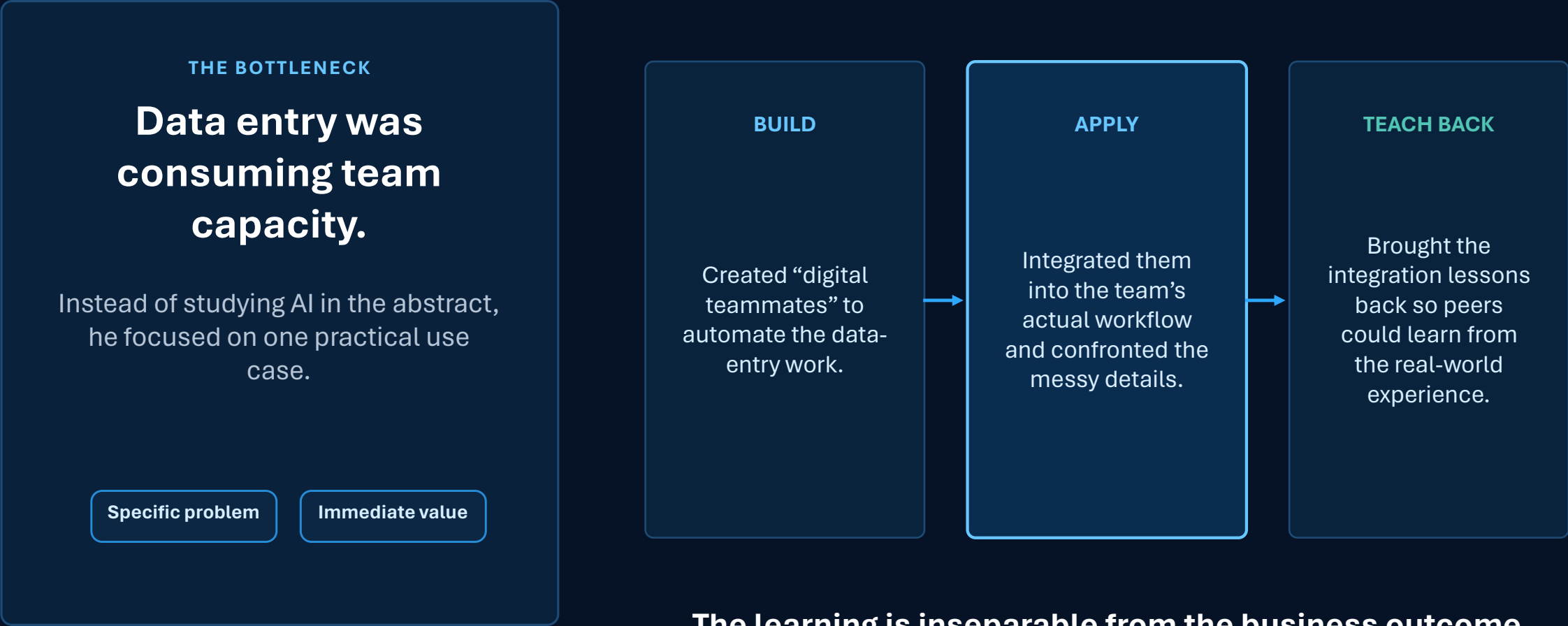
## The North Star: Learn → Apply → Teach Back



# A job bottleneck becomes the curriculum at the moment of need



# Case example: Ken Smith at Canon



## Teach back turns experience into evidence—not just anecdotes

1

### FOR THE MEMBER

Explaining the work forces the member to translate tools and prompts into clear business logic. That strengthens understanding and credibility.

2

### FOR THE PEERS

Peers can question assumptions, compare contexts, identify failure points, and decide what is actually reusable.

3

### FOR AILA

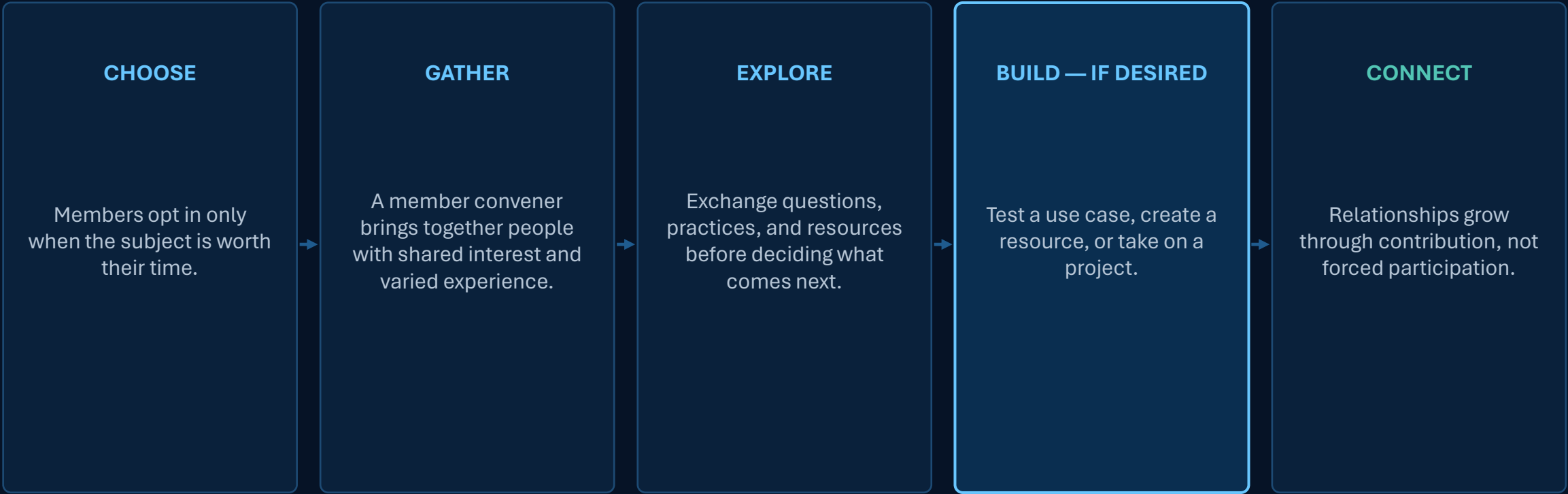
Selected, validated lessons can become demonstrations, practice guides, papers, events, and eventually standards or influence.

**A useful analogy: disciplined field testing—specific intervention, observed results, peer review.**



# SIGs give applied learning a home without making it mandatory

A SIG can stay a discussion group—or choose to build something.



Examples for an initial wave: L&D • Sales Enablement • HR • Sales

# The convener owns the problem. The Board enables the system.

MEMBER CONVENER

**Domain context is the qualification.**

The convener does not need to be the strongest AI technologist. The convener needs to understand where the work breaks, what success looks like, and why the problem matters.

- Define purpose
- Set scope
- Invite peers
- Own the work

AILA BOARD

**Govern, connect, recruit, review.**

The Board protects member choice, opens doors to experts and partners, connects the right people, and reviews what produces real value.

- Open doors
- Protect choice
- Connect
- Review

# Optional by design is a strength—not a compromise

**High-quality collaboration comes from shared interest and willingness to contribute.**

## WHAT WE DO NOT BUILD

- ✗ Mandatory project tracks
- ✗ Board-managed weekly work
- ✗ One “all members” journey
- ✗ Projects chosen only for prestige

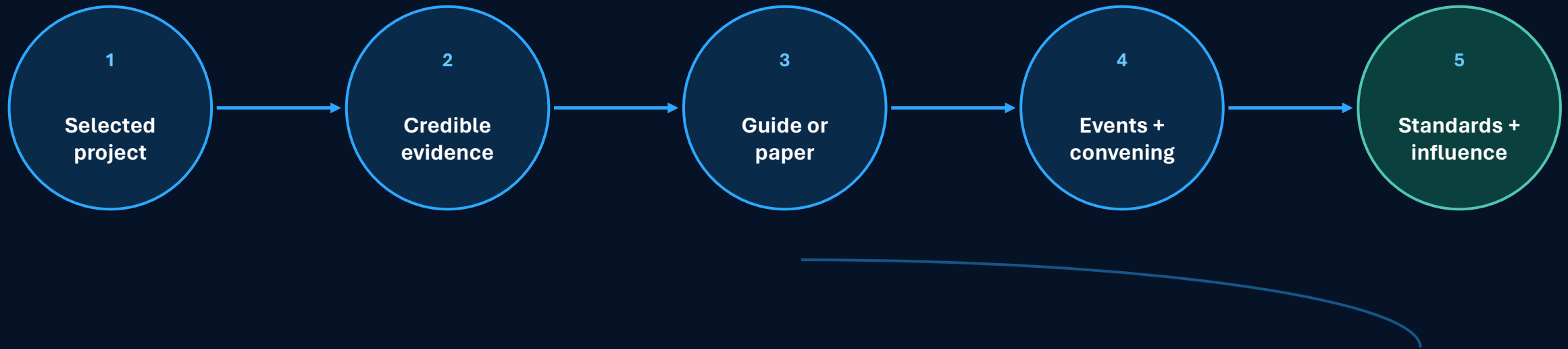
## WHAT WE ENABLE

- ✓ Voluntary SIGs
- ✓ Member-convened projects
- ✓ Learning at the moment of need
- ✓ A stage for sharing when useful

**The paradox: less forced participation can create more motivated, more credible work.**

# The best SIG work can become AILA thought leadership

Thought leadership is an output of the system—not a requirement placed on every member.



Useful publications attract members, experts, partners, and trust—feeding the next wave of participation.

# A disciplined rollout: listen, add, support, expand



**Start close to the work. Learn from participation before expanding the model.**

# The Board-level choice

**We are not choosing between learning and community.**

We are choosing to make learning more valuable inside a community where members can connect, apply, and optionally collaborate.

- 1 One clear member promise
- 2 Core learning + community value for every member
- 3 Optional SIGs organized around shared interests
- 4 Projects, demonstrations, and publications when SIGs choose
- 5 **A Board that governs, connects, recruits, and enables**

**Board question: What specific bottleneck could a member solve today that might become a reusable AILA practice tomorrow?**